

Section A – Question 1 (translation) into assessed language

This task is marked using a points-based mark scheme in which 1 mark is given for each correct individual section of language. Please see the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in French Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document for an example of how the translation will be marked.

Sections B and C – Questions 2 to 26 (written response to works)

There are three levels-based mark grids to be applied to each individual essay that makes up the written response to works. The mark grids are:

- Critical and analytical response (AO4)
- Range of grammatical structures and vocabulary (AO3)
- Accuracy of language (AO3).

General guidance on using levels-based mark schemes

Step 1: Decide on a band

- The examiner will first of all consider the answer as a whole and then decide which descriptors most closely match the answer and place it in that band. The descriptors for each band indicate the different features that will be seen in the student's answer for that band.
- When assigning a level, the examiner will look at the overall quality of the answer and not focus disproportionately on small and specific parts of the answer where the student has not performed quite as well as the rest. If the answer covers different aspects of different bands of the mark scheme, the examiner will use a 'best fit' approach for defining the level and then use the variability of the response to help decide the mark within the level, for example if the response is predominantly band 5–8 with a small amount of band 9–12 material, it would be placed in band 5–8 but be awarded a mark near the top of the band because of the band 9–12 content.

Step 2: Decide on a mark

- Once the examiner has decided on a band they will need to decide on a mark within the band.
- They will decide on the mark to award based on the quality of the answer; they will award a mark towards the top or bottom of that band depending on how the student has evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- The examiner will modify the mark based on how securely the trait descriptors are met at that band.
- They will need to go back through the answer as they apply the mark scheme to clarify points and assure themselves that the band and the mark are appropriate.

Critical and analytical response (AO4)

- This mark grid assesses students' ability to respond critically and analytically to the aspect of the literary work or film outlined in the question. To provide a critical and analytical response, students should select relevant material, present and justify points of view, develop arguments, draw conclusions based on understanding and evaluate issues, themes and cultural and social contexts.
- This grid will be applied twice, once for each essay individually.
- When deciding how to reward an answer, examiners will consult this mark grid as well as the indicative content associated with each question which can be found in the document *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in French Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)*. Indicative content contains points that students are likely to use to construct their answer. It is possible for an answer to be constructed without mentioning some or all of these points as long as students provide alternative responses that fulfil the requirements of the question.

Marks	Description
0	No rewardable material.
1–4	• Points of view relating to issues/themes/cultural or social contexts are presented, with simplistic justification; limited interpretation with frequent misunderstanding or confusion; any evidence from the work is descriptive. • Limited ability to form arguments or draw conclusions. • Response relates to the work but limited focus on the question.
5–8	• Points of view relating to issues/themes/cultural or social contexts are presented, with attempts made at interpretation, but they occasionally show misunderstanding or confusion; evidence selected from the work for justification is occasionally appropriate but often descriptive. • Arguments are made but with inconsistencies; conclusions are drawn but do not fully link to arguments. • Response relates to the work but often loses focus on the question.
9–12	• Critical analysis of issues/themes/cultural or social contexts is evident in relation to particular aspects of the question, with some appropriate interpretations and points of view, sometimes justified by appropriately selected evidence from the work. • Logical arguments are followed through on particular aspects of the question, occasionally detailed and with linked conclusions; some points are made without exploration. • Response is relevant to particular aspects of the question, occasional loss of focus.
13–16	• Critical analysis of issues/themes/cultural or social contexts is frequently demonstrated, with some convincing interpretations and points of view, predominantly justified with appropriately selected evidence from the work. • Generally detailed, logical arguments are made, with some persuasive conclusions that mostly link together. • Predominantly relevant response to the question.
17–20	• Critical analysis of issues/themes/cultural or social contexts is demonstrated through convincing interpretations and points of view, consistently justified with appropriately selected evidence from the work. • Detailed, logical arguments and conclusions are made that consistently link together. • Relevant response to the question throughout.

Range of grammatical structures and vocabulary (A03)

- This mark grid assesses students' ability to use a range of grammatical structures and vocabulary in order to produce articulate written communication with a range of expression.
- This grid will be applied twice, once for each essay individually.

Marks	Description
0	No rewardable language.
1–4	• Limited variation of straightforward grammatical structures with much repetition, producing writing that is often restricted and stilted. • Limited range of vocabulary resulting in repetitive expression. • Limited use of terminology appropriate to literary and cinematic analysis.
5–8	• Occasional variation in use of mostly straightforward grammatical structures, infrequent use of complex language, producing writing that is sometimes stilted. • Vocabulary is mostly high frequency with occasional variation, expression is frequently repetitive. • Occasional use of terminology appropriate for literary and cinematic analysis.
9–12	• Some variation in the use of grammatical structures, including some recurrent examples of complex language; sections of articulate writing with occasionally stilted phrasing. • Some variation in use of vocabulary, resulting in variation of expression but this is not sustained. • Some use of terminology appropriate for literary and cinematic analysis.
13–16	• Frequent variation in use of grammatical structures, including different types of complex language, producing writing that is articulate throughout the majority of the essay. • Frequently varied use of vocabulary, resulting in regular variation of expression. • Frequent use of terminology appropriate for literary and cinematic analysis.
17–20	• Consistent variation in use of grammatical structures, including in use of complex language, producing consistently articulate writing. • Consistently varied use of vocabulary, allowing ideas to be conveyed in a variety of different ways. • Consistent use of terminology appropriate for literary and cinematic analysis.

Additional guidance

Variation of vocabulary and grammatical structures: the traits in the mark grid differentiate between the variation of grammatical structures and vocabulary used by students. Examiners will judge in which mark band to place students and which mark to award, based on the effect that the variety of grammatical structures and vocabulary has on the quality of the communication; the wider the variety, the more articulate the communication will become (see definition of *articulate* below).

Examples of a variety of grammatical structures and vocabulary are: a selection of different verbs, tenses, adjectives, vocabulary, including to express literary and cinematic analysis (see further detail below), complex language (see definition below) for a variety of purposes, including to present and justify points of view, develop arguments, draw conclusions based on understanding.

Articulate: articulate communication is fluent, effective and coherent as students control/manipulate the language to say what they want to say rather than what they can say, for a number of different purposes. If students are restricted to what they can say, they may not be able to express themselves for all purposes, for example to develop arguments.

Terminology for literary and cinematic analysis: vocabulary for critical analysis according to the work being studied, for example 'plot', 'character'; figures of speech such as 'metaphor', 'similes'; to describe theme and style such as, 'camera technique', 'hand-held camera', 'use of black and white', 'first person narrative.'

Complex language is considered to include the following:

- conceptually challenging tenses such as the pluperfect, future perfect
- passive voice
- subjunctive mood
- use of relative pronouns
- using extended sentences to express abstract ideas/convey justified arguments that require a range of lexis and structures, for example conjunctions and pronouns
- using synonyms and a variety of expressions to say things in different ways
- all grammar and structures included in the grammar list that are specific to A Level.

Straightforward language is considered to be:

- simple sentences with limited linking of sentences and clauses
- high frequency grammatical structures and vocabulary.

Accuracy of language (AO3)

- This mark grid assesses students' ability to apply grammar and syntax accurately.
- This grid will be applied twice, once for each essay individually.

Marks	Description
0	No rewardable language.
1–2	• Limited sequences of accurate language resulting in lapses in coherence. • Errors occur that often prevent meaning being conveyed.
3–4	• Some accurate sequences of language resulting in some coherent writing. • Errors occur that sometimes hinder clarity of communication and occasionally prevent meaning being conveyed.
5–6	• Frequent sequences of accurate language resulting in generally coherent writing. • Errors occur that occasionally hinder clarity of communication
7–8	• Accurate language throughout most of the essay, resulting in mostly coherent writing. • Errors occur that rarely hinder clarity of communication.
9–10	• Accurate language throughout, resulting in consistently coherent writing. • Any errors do not hinder clarity of communication.

Additional guidance

Errors: students are not expected to produce perfect, error-free writing in order to access the top band as errors are also made by native speakers. The mark grid describes the frequency of errors and the impact that errors have on coherence.

Errors that **do not hinder clarity:**

- errors that do not affect meaning, for example gender, adjectival agreements
- infrequent errors that do not distract the reader from the content and which result in coherent writing.

Errors that **hinder clarity:**

- errors that make writing difficult to understand immediately (even if the meaning is eventually understood)/errors that force readers to re-read in order to understand what is meant, for example inappropriate tense formation, mismatch of subject and the possessive adjective
- frequent errors hinder clarity as they will distract the reader from the content of the writing.

Errors that **prevent meaning being conveyed:**

- errors that mean the reader cannot understand the message
- errors that convey the wrong message
- errors that make it unclear who is carrying out the action, for example using the incorrect person of the verb
- mother-tongue interference.

NB: these are examples only and do not constitute a finite list.